Data Cleaning – Before & After

Sample portfolio file by Yousef Alkhateeb – all names, phones and emails are fictional.

The task	A raw beneficiary list exported from several forms: duplicates, mixed name cases, 17 spellings of 5 cities, 5 phone formats, 5 date formats and text inside number columns.
The result	One clean, de-duplicated table that can be filtered, counted and imported into any system.
Sheets	1. Before (Raw) – the data as received 2. After (Clean) – the cleaned table with a Data Check column 3. Cleaning Log – every fix, with live counts
Tools	Microsoft Excel: TRIM/PROPER, Find & Replace, Text to Columns, Remove Duplicates, data validation, formulas, conditional formatting.
Turnaround	A file like this (≈50 rows) is cleaned within a few hours; thousands of rows within 1–3 days.

Full Name	City	Phone	Registration Date	Family Members	Program	Email
Asma Nasser			16 August 2026	1 persons	Food parcel	asma.nasser@example.com
YAHYA HADDAD	Rafah	+970 594 464 264	10/08/2026	6 persons	water voucher	yahya.haddad@example.com
tariq darwish	nuseirat	00970592959077	26/09/2026	9	Cash assistance	TARIQ.DARWISH@EXAMPLE.COM
DINA SHAHEEN	Rafah	597971464	01/08/2026	3	Cash assistance	dina.shaheen@example.com
Noor Hassan	Khanyounis	+970 592 280 718	19 September 2026	8	Food parcel	noor.hassan@example.com
Lina Qasem	Gaza		2026-09-09	4	Cash assistance	lina.qasem@example.com
TARIQ DARWISH	nuseirat	00970592959077	26/09/2026	9	Cash assistance	TARIQ.DARWISH@EXAMPLE.COM
reem hamdan	RAFAH	0596251262	2026-08-19	2	cash assistance	reem.hamdan@example.com
Fadi Mansour	Deir Al Balah		11/09/2026	9	cash assistance	fadi.mansour@example.com
Huda Saleh	nuseirat		24/09/2026	8	Cash assistance	HUDA.SALEH@EXAMPLE.COM
Aya Nasser		00970592278261	16/09/2026	1 persons	hygiene kit	aya.nasser@example.com
ZIAD HAMDAN	rafah	+970 591 481 272	04.09.2026	1	Food parcel	ziad.hamdan@example.com
Reem Odeh	rafah	00970598656506	21 August 2026	8	food parcel	reem.odeh@example.com
Fadi Shaheen	Deir al-Balah	0599-441-824	2026-09-18	9 persons	Water voucher	FADI.SHAHEEN@EXAMPLE.COM
ZIAD NAJJAR	RAFAH	0592741281	21 September 2026	8	Cash assistance	ziad.najjar@example.com
AYA NAJJAR	Gaza	+970 599 176 756	19/08/2026	9	Water voucher	AYA.NAJJAR@EXAMPLE.COM
Sami Hamdan	rafah		26-Aug-26	2	cash assistance	sami.hamdan@example.com
Reem Nasser	Khan Younis	590749078	06/09/2026	8 persons	water voucher	REEM.NASSER@EXAMPLE.COM
SAMI NAJJAR	deir el-balah	0597479146	07/09/2026	4	Hygiene kit	sami.najjar@example.com
yahya abed	GAZA	0595482348	08/29/2026	4	food parcel	yahya.abed@example.com
Fadi Hassan	Khan Younis	0598-479-324	14-Aug-26	9	Food parcel	FADI.HASSAN@EXAMPLE.COM
noor khalil	gaza	597542182	10 August 2026	11	Food parcel	noor.khalil@example.com
Nader Qasem	Gaza City	+970 595 729 908	08-Aug-26	2 persons	Food parcel	NADER.QASEM@EXAMPLE.COM
wael shaheen	rafah		2026-08-06	8	Cash assistance	wael.shaheen@example.com
Fadi Shaheen	Deir al-Balah	0599-441-824	2026-09-18	9 persons	Water voucher	FADI.SHAHEEN@EXAMPLE.COM
amal matar	nuseirat	0595-314-301	13 August 2026	10	food parcel	amal.matar@example.com
reem khalil	Nusirat	+970 595 723 241	22 August 2026	10	Water voucher	reem.khalil@example.com
Hani Najjar	deir el-balah	0596801133	2026-08-19	1	water voucher	hani.najjar@example.com
Huda Matar	Khanyounis		10/09/2026	2	hygiene kit	huda.matar@example.com
Sami Najjar	deir el-balah	0597479146	07/09/2026	4	Hygiene kit	sami.najjar@example.com
Wael Shaheen	rafah		2026-08-06	8	Cash assistance	wael.shaheen@example.com
REEM QASEM	Khanyounis	0599-698-951	2026-08-07	6	Food parcel	reem.qasem@example.com
Omar Hamdan	Gaza City	+970 590 938 186	02-Aug-26	9	Hygiene kit	omar.hamdan@example.com
Yahya Matar	Deir Al Balah		23-Aug-26	8	cash assistance	yahya.matar@example.com
Khaled Nasser	gaza		30/09/2026	1	Cash assistance	khaled.nasser@example.com
Asma Barakat	Dair al Balah	+970 593 129 353	2026-09-22	4	Cash assistance	asma.barakat@example.com

Record ID	Full Name	City	Phone (+970)	Registration Date	Family Members	Program	Email	Data Check
BEN-2001	Dina Shaheen	Rafah	+970 597 971 464	01-Aug-2026	3	Cash assistance	dina.shaheen@example.com	Complete
BEN-2002	Omar Hamdan	Gaza	+970 590 938 186	02-Aug-2026	9	Hygiene kit	omar.hamdan@example.com	Complete
BEN-2003	Wael Shaheen	Rafah		06-Aug-2026	8	Cash assistance	wael.shaheen@example.com	Missing: Phone
BEN-2004	Reem Qasem	Khan Younis	+970 599 698 951	07-Aug-2026	6	Food parcel	reem.qasem@example.com	Complete
BEN-2005	Khaled Hamdan	Deir al-Balah	+970 595 876 314	07-Aug-2026	8	Hygiene kit	khaled.hamdan@example.com	Complete
BEN-2006	Nader Qasem	Gaza	+970 595 729 908	08-Aug-2026	2	Food parcel	nader.qasem@example.com	Complete
BEN-2007	Yahya Haddad	Rafah	+970 594 464 264	10-Aug-2026	6	Water voucher	yahya.haddad@example.com	Complete
BEN-2008	Noor Khalil	Gaza	+970 597 542 182	10-Aug-2026	11	Food parcel	noor.khalil@example.com	Complete
BEN-2009	Rana Hassan	Deir al-Balah	+970 596 660 559	10-Aug-2026	10	Cash assistance	rana.hassan@example.com	Complete
BEN-2010	Amal Matar	Nuseirat	+970 595 314 301	13-Aug-2026	10	Food parcel	amal.matar@example.com	Complete
BEN-2011	Fadi Hassan	Khan Younis	+970 598 479 324	14-Aug-2026	9	Food parcel	fadi.hassan@example.com	Complete
BEN-2012	Asma Nasser			16-Aug-2026	1	Food parcel	asma.nasser@example.com	Missing: City Phone
BEN-2013	Reem Hamdan	Rafah	+970 596 251 262	19-Aug-2026	2	Cash assistance	reem.hamdan@example.com	Complete
BEN-2014	Aya Najjar	Gaza	+970 599 176 756	19-Aug-2026	9	Water voucher	aya.najjar@example.com	Complete
BEN-2015	Hani Najjar	Deir al-Balah	+970 596 801 133	19-Aug-2026	1	Water voucher	hani.najjar@example.com	Complete
BEN-2016	Reem Odeh	Rafah	+970 598 656 506	21-Aug-2026	8	Food parcel	reem.odeh@example.com	Complete
BEN-2017	Reem Khalil	Nuseirat	+970 595 723 241	22-Aug-2026	10	Water voucher	reem.khalil@example.com	Complete
BEN-2018	Yahya Matar	Deir al-Balah		23-Aug-2026	8	Cash assistance	yahya.matar@example.com	Missing: Phone
BEN-2019	Wael Awad	Khan Younis	+970 596 341 960	23-Aug-2026	2	Hygiene kit	wael.awad@example.com	Complete
BEN-2020	Sami Hamdan	Rafah		26-Aug-2026	2	Cash assistance	sami.hamdan@example.com	Missing: Phone
BEN-2021	Omar Shaheen	Gaza	+970 596 620 625	26-Aug-2026	3	Water voucher	omar.shaheen@example.com	Complete
BEN-2022	Hiba Qasem	Nuseirat		28-Aug-2026	8	Water voucher	hiba.qasem@example.com	Missing: Phone
BEN-2023	Yahya Abed	Gaza	+970 595 482 348	29-Aug-2026	4	Food parcel	yahya.abed@example.com	Complete
BEN-2024	Omar Odeh	Nuseirat	+970 598 511 439	30-Aug-2026	7	Water voucher	omar.odeh@example.com	Complete
BEN-2025	Ziad Hamdan	Rafah	+970 591 481 272	04-Sep-2026	1	Food parcel	ziad.hamdan@example.com	Complete
BEN-2026	Fadi Hamdan	Rafah		04-Sep-2026	1	Water voucher	fadi.hamdan@example.com	Missing: Phone
BEN-2027	Reem Nasser	Khan Younis	+970 590 749 078	06-Sep-2026	8	Water voucher	reem.nasser@example.com	Complete
BEN-2028	Amal Odeh	Gaza	+970 599 515 949	06-Sep-2026	4	Food parcel	amal.odeh@example.com	Complete
BEN-2029	Sami Najjar	Deir al-Balah	+970 597 479 146	07-Sep-2026	4	Hygiene kit	sami.najjar@example.com	Complete
BEN-2030	Lina Qasem	Gaza		09-Sep-2026	4	Cash assistance	lina.qasem@example.com	Missing: Phone
BEN-2031	Hani Shaheen	Khan Younis		09-Sep-2026	7	Hygiene kit	hani.shaheen@example.com	Missing: Phone
BEN-2032	Huda Matar	Khan Younis		10-Sep-2026	2	Hygiene kit	huda.matar@example.com	Missing: Phone
BEN-2033	Fadi Mansour	Deir al-Balah		11-Sep-2026	9	Cash assistance	fadi.mansour@example.com	Missing: Phone
BEN-2034	Aya Nasser		+970 592 278 261	16-Sep-2026	1	Hygiene kit	aya.nasser@example.com	Missing: City
BEN-2035	Fadi Shaheen	Deir al-Balah	+970 599 441 824	18-Sep-2026	9	Water voucher	fadi.shaheen@example.com	Complete
BEN-2036	Noor Hassan	Khan Younis	+970 592 280 718	19-Sep-2026	8	Food parcel	noor.hassan@example.com	Complete
BEN-2037	Noor Abed	Rafah		19-Sep-2026	9	Cash assistance	noor.abed@example.com	Missing: Phone
BEN-2038	Ziad Najjar	Rafah	+970 592 741 281	21-Sep-2026	8	Cash assistance	ziad.najjar@example.com	Complete
BEN-2039	Hiba Abed	Gaza		21-Sep-2026	7	Hygiene kit	hiba.abed@example.com	Missing: Phone
BEN-2040	Asma Barakat	Deir al-Balah	+970 593 129 353	22-Sep-2026	4	Cash assistance	asma.barakat@example.com	Complete
BEN-2041	Huda Saleh	Nuseirat		24-Sep-2026	8	Cash assistance	huda.saleh@example.com	Missing: Phone
BEN-2042	Tariq Darwish	Nuseirat	+970 592 959 077	26-Sep-2026	9	Cash assistance	tariq.darwish@example.com	Complete

What was fixed

Check	Result	How it was handled
Rows received (raw)	**52**	Original export, no changes.
Duplicate records removed	**7**	Same person entered twice with different spacing/case – kept one record.
Clean, unique records	**45**	Each record given a unique Record ID (BEN-xxxx).
Names standardised	**45**	Trimmed extra spaces, Proper Case (e.g. 'AHMAD HASSAN' → 'Ahmad Hassan').
City spellings unified	**42**	17 spelling variants mapped to 5 standard city names.
Phone numbers standardised	**31**	All formats (00970…, 059-…, missing 0) converted to +970 5X XXX XXXX.
Dates converted to real dates	**45**	5 text formats incl. mixed day/month order (31/08/2026, 2026-08-31, 31-Aug-26 …) → real dates.
Family size made numeric	**45**	Removed text such as '5 persons' so totals and averages work.
Records still missing data	**16**	Flagged in the 'Data Check' column for follow-up – not guessed.
Total individuals (clean data)	**262**	Now possible because family size is numeric.